Minutes of the Ordinary 2026 General Assembly of Départ de Sentier

Place: Aalborg, Denmark and online
Date: 24.09.2026

Note taker: Mélanie Douziech. These notes complete the GA slides, which are public on https://github.com/Depart-de-Sentier/Legal/tree/main/General%20Assemblies/2026 .

1. Welcome & confirmation of quorum

The GA opens at 18:24.

Karin Treyer leads this GA. She introduces the concept of general assembly to the people present.

Two people online, one of it left at 18:45. Of it one board member (João Gonçalves).
16 people onsite, of it 4 board members.
Total until 18:45: 18 votes
Total after 18:45: 17 votes
Total for board discharge (board members abstain from voting): 12 votes

A presence list circulates during the GA. DdS keeps the presence list, but doesn't make it public.

2. Election of vote counters

Given the small number of people: only one voter.
Louis Freboeuf is appointed unanimously as vote counter.

3. Approval of the minutes of the last GA

Karin Treyer shows the minutes of the GA of 2025. It was an extraordinary GA, because it was the first time the GA was switched from Spring to Autumn.

Minutes of the last GA are approved unanimously.

4. Annual report 2025/2026 - approval

The DdS Director, Xiaojin Zhang, presents the activities of 2025/2026 (project acquisition, strategic workshop etc)

Annual report 2025/2026 was approved unanimously.

5. Annual accounts 2025, auditors' report - approval

Xiaojin Zhang presents the financial statement of 2025 (jupyter notebook to produce the balance is available on github), the income, expenses and balance. Summer schools and Brightway profits are shown together with the project grants.

The balance was negative at -11kCHF by the end of 2025. Xiaojin Zhang explains that this doesn't mean a loss, but just that project money due was not received yet.
The financial statement of 2025 was audited by Anne Ventura. She cannot be here today, so Karin reads it out for her. The report declares that the financial audit is closed positively.

Manuel Klarmann asks where the money of the ADEME project went? Answer: Mainly for the software engineer hired in 2025 during a few months and a subcontract with Cauldron.

A member asks where the profit of the Autumn School, Summer School etc. goes to? Answer: On the salary of the DdS director Xiaojin Zhang who spends time organising those events.

Members ask to write down the hours "volunteering" to write proposals, organise Brightcon, organise Autumn Schools. It will allow us to better track the hours. Member mentions that it could also be a good way to know which institutions support the work of DdS with in-kind contributions.

Annual accounts 2025 were approved unanimously
Auditor's report available on Github.

6. Auditors' report for accounts 2024 (open issue)

No auditor's report for the accounts 2024 was prepared before the extraordinary general assembly (EGA) 2025, but the accounts were checked after that EGA by two DdS members who wrote an auditor report each. Karin Treyer presents those reports, which are also available on Github.

7. Discharge of the Board — 2023, 2024, 2025 - approval

The board had not been discharged officially in past general assemblies. In 2023, only board members were present at the GA, who didn't discharge themselves. For 2024, no discharge was voted on during the GA. For 2025, the auditor's report(s) were missing and not discharged was voted on during the GA.
This year's GA aims to catch up with these missing discharges with three votes. Board members abstain from voting.

Board discharged for 2023 unanimously.
Board discharged for 2024 unanimously.
Board discharged for 2025 unanimously.

8. Outlook 2026/2027

Xiaojin informs about planned activities.

9. Forecast budget 2027 - approval

Karin Treyer and Xiaojin Zhang inform that no complete budget forecast for 2027 can be presented as per the date of this GA. Only the expenses were prepared and the incomes are not flowing continuously.
Members cannot approve the forecast budget. **Karin suggests an extraordinary assembly soon/in 2 months to handle this agenda point. This was approved unanimously.** The GA approved without a vote that DdS can continue working until then.

10. Amendment of the Statutes (Art. 8, 9, 10, 11, 13) - votes

All suggested amendments have been part of the invitation to this GA. Karin Treyer shows the suggested changes in the Statues, and informs that the German version of the statutes is the legally binding version.
Chris explains that Xiaojin applied for DdS to be a "tax-exempt non-profit organisation" and that it is important to follow all procedures and do things correctly.

Member asks about the hybrid nature of this GA: The statutes is mentioned that the GA may be held physically or online. Member mentions that it is not clear whether hybrid is also ok. It was discussed that this could be clarified in a next GA, or that "physical or online" includes hybrid.

The three amendments to article 8 were unanimously approved.

Article 9:
The board shares the forms about conflicts of interest on the DdS Git for all members to see. The board members decide if they recuse themselves.

The members can always raise questions about decisions made during the GA for the board to explain.
The two amendments to article 9 were unanimously approved.

The amendment in article 10 was approved unanimously.
The amendment in article 11 was approved unanimously.
The amendment in article 13 was approved unanimously.

11. Election of the auditor(s)

DdS has not had an elected auditor in the past years, even if Anne Ventura and Aleksandra Kim have acted as official auditors.
Chris Mutel reads the email of Anne Ventura from the 22nd of September who presents herself as a candidate for being elected as auditor.
A member asks if it's a problem to have the same auditor all the time. Karin Treyer answers no, the power is still with the GA if they want the auditor to be changed.

Anne Ventura is unanimously elected as auditor.

12. Board elections

No vote is required.

13. Proposals of members - none

No additional agenda point was received.

14. Other business (Varia)

- Autumn / Summer school organisation

If anybody is ready to organise such an autumn school, DdS is more than willing to provide some support. Inputting all the voluntary, in-kind contributions is not necessarily possible.

- Budget 2026

Xiaojin Zhang shows the provisional forecast for 2026 she prepared.
A member asks what is missing in this budget. Xiaojin explains that the income is missing.

To sustain the expenses, we need to acquire 100'000CHF by the end of 2026 because the cash-flow doesn't allow us. Not too much income/expense.

- Closing

The GA was closed at 19:40